

Unusual2NT

Unusual 2NT

A jump to 2NT over an opponent's opening bid to show the **two lowest unbid suits**.

The Convention

2NT (jump) over an opponent's opening = 5+ cards in each of the two lowest unbid suits

Opponent opens	Your 2NT shows
1 ♥	Clubs and diamonds (the two lowest unbid suits)
1 ♠	Clubs and diamonds
1 ♣	Diamonds and hearts
1 ♦	Clubs and hearts

Point Range / Strength

Unusual 2NT is primarily a **shape bid**, not an HCP bid — suit quality and distribution matter more than point count.

Vulnerability	Typical strength
Not vulnerable	~6-11 HCP; prioritize suit quality over points
Vulnerable	~8-11+ HCP; suits should be headed by at least a Q or better

With 12+ HCP and 5-5 shape, the hand may be strong enough to act differently (e.g., overcall then bid again). Very strong 5-5 hands should usually not preempt with 2NT — they deserve more.

Responses by Partner (Advancer)

Advancer **must** choose a suit — the 2NT bidder has shown 5-5, so partner picks the better fit.

Advancer bid	Meaning
3 of lower suit	Preference, to play; weak hand (0-8)
3 of higher suit	Preference, to play; weak hand (0-8)
4 of lower suit	Preemptive; good fit, weak hand
4 of higher suit	Preemptive; good fit, weak hand
Cue bid of opponent's suit	Game-forcing; asks 2NT bidder to clarify better/longer suit

Cue bid = “I want to be in game, tell me more.” The 2NT bidder rebids the longer or better suit, which advancer converts to game.

Unusual 2NT vs. Natural 2NT

A 2NT overcall is **unusual** (showing two-suited hand) when made as a direct jump over an opening bid at the 1-level.

A 2NT bid is **not Unusual** when: - Made over an opponent's **1NT** opening — we play WONT instead - Made after an opponent's weak two-bid (e.g., 2♠ - **2NT** = natural, strong balanced 15-18) - Made as a response or rebid in an uncontested auction

When in doubt: if a natural 2NT makes sense given the auction, treat it as natural. If it's a jump overcall over a **suit** opening at the 1-level, it's unusual.